

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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## 1. ACADEMY STRUCTURE

MEAL Bridge Academy is structured around progressive professional development:

### *LEVEL 1 — EXPLORE*

For individuals entering or exploring the MEAL profession.

### *LEVEL 2 — PRACTICE*

For professionals developing core technical MEAL competencies.

### *LEVEL 3 — DESIGN*

For professionals designing and strengthening MEAL systems.

### *LEVEL 4 — SPECIALIZE*

For professionals developing advanced or context-specific expertise.

### *LEVEL 5 — LEAD*

For experienced professionals managing MEAL functions, teams, and organizational learning.

The Academy offers two main product types:

1. Individual Courses
2. Professional Learning Pathways

Individual courses provide focused competencies.

Learning pathways combine courses into a structured professional development journey.

## 2. INDIVIDUAL COURSE CATALOGUE

### COURSE 1: MEAL FUNDAMENTALS

Level: Explore

Recommended Duration: 2–3 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 8–12 hours

Individual Price: USD 75

#### *Target Audience:*

- Individuals new to MEAL
- Junior MEAL staff
- Project and program staff
- NGO and humanitarian professionals
- Volunteers and community-based organization staff
- Students and graduates interested in MEAL
- Professionals transitioning into the MEAL field

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### *Course Purpose:*

MEAL Fundamentals introduces learners to Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning and explains how these functions contribute to effective project and organizational performance.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Understanding MEAL
2. The Project and Program Cycle
3. Results-Based Thinking
4. Theory of Change and Results Chains
5. Logical Frameworks and Results Frameworks
6. Introduction to Indicators
7. Introduction to Data and Evidence
8. Introduction to Accountability
9. Introduction to Learning
10. How MEAL Components Work Together

### *Learning Outcomes:*

- By the end of the course, participants will be able to:
- Explain the purpose and role of MEAL.
- Describe the relationship between monitoring, evaluation, accountability and learning.
- Explain how MEAL relates to the project and program cycle.
- Understand basic results-based management concepts.
- Distinguish between outputs, outcomes and impacts.
- Explain the purpose of a Theory of Change and results framework.
- Understand the role of indicators in measuring performance.
- Explain the importance of accountability and community participation.
- Describe how evidence supports decision-making and learning.
- Explain how the major components of MEAL operate as an integrated system.

### *Final Learning Output:*

A basic MEAL framework for a hypothetical or real project.

## COURSE 2: BUILDING A MEAL CAREER

Level: Explore

Recommended Duration: 1–2 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 5–8 hours

Individual Price: USD 60

### *Target Audience:*

- Students and graduates
- Individuals entering the humanitarian and development sector

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## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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- Junior MEAL professionals
- Professionals transitioning into MEAL
- Volunteers seeking a professional career in MEAL

### *Course Purpose:*

This course helps participants understand MEAL career opportunities, develop a professional development plan, and prepare for employment and progression in the field.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Understanding MEAL Career Paths
2. MEAL Roles and Competencies
3. Building a MEAL CV
4. Job Applications
5. Interview Preparation
6. Technical Writing
7. Professional Communication
8. Professional Ethics
9. Career Planning
10. Becoming an Independent MEAL Consultant

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Identify common MEAL career pathways.
- Understand the competencies required at different career levels.
- Assess their own professional strengths and development needs.
- Develop a targeted MEAL career plan.
- Improve their CV and professional profile.
- Prepare for MEAL job applications and interviews.
- Understand professional ethics and expectations.
- Identify potential pathways toward consultancy and independent work.

### *Final Learning Output:*

A personal MEAL Career Development Plan.

## COURSE 3: MONITORING AND INDICATOR SYSTEMS

Level: Practitioner

Recommended Duration: 3–5 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 15–25 hours

Individual Price: USD 150

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### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL Officers
- Monitoring Officers
- Project Officers
- Program Managers
- MEAL Assistants
- Project staff responsible for monitoring
- NGO and humanitarian professionals

### *Course Purpose:*

This course develops the practical skills required to design, implement and manage effective monitoring and indicator systems.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Monitoring Concepts and Principles
2. Results Chains and Monitoring Logic
3. Indicator Design
4. Indicator Quality and Selection
5. Indicator Reference Sheets
6. Monitoring Plans
7. Monitoring Tools and Tracking Systems
8. Field Monitoring
9. Output and Outcome Monitoring
10. Monitoring Data Interpretation
11. Monitoring Reporting

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Explain the purpose and role of monitoring.
- Develop appropriate indicators.
- Assess indicator quality.
- Develop indicator reference sheets.
- Design monitoring plans.
- Select appropriate monitoring methods and tools.
- Develop monitoring tracking systems.
- Conduct effective field monitoring.
- Distinguish between output and outcome monitoring.
- Interpret monitoring data.
- Prepare useful monitoring reports.

### *Final Learning Output:*

A complete monitoring and indicator framework for a project.

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## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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### COURSE 4: EVALUATION DESIGN AND PRACTICE

Level: Practitioner

Recommended Duration: 4–5 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 20–30 hours

Individual Price: USD 200

#### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL Officers
- Evaluation Officers
- MEAL Managers
- Researchers
- Program Managers
- Consultants
- Professionals responsible for commissioning or managing evaluations

#### *Course Purpose:*

This course provides participants with the knowledge and practical skills to design, manage and use evaluations.

#### *Core Sessions:*

1. Understanding Evaluation
2. Evaluation Questions
3. Evaluation Criteria
4. Evaluation Designs
5. Baseline, Mid-Term and Endline Evaluations
6. Qualitative Methods
7. Quantitative Methods
8. Mixed-Methods Evaluation
9. Evaluation Terms of Reference
10. Managing External Evaluations
11. Evaluation Quality
12. Using Evaluation Findings

#### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Explain the purpose and role of evaluation.
- Develop appropriate evaluation questions.
- Select suitable evaluation criteria.
- Understand different evaluation designs.
- Distinguish between baseline, mid-term and endline evaluations.
- Select appropriate qualitative and quantitative methods.
- Understand mixed-methods approaches.
- Develop an evaluation Terms of Reference.

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## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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- Manage an external evaluation process.
- Assess the quality of evaluation evidence.
- Develop recommendations from evaluation findings.

### *Final Learning Output:*

An evaluation design or evaluation Terms of Reference.

## COURSE 5: ACCOUNTABILITY AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Level: Practitioner

Recommended Duration: 3–4 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 15–20 hours

Individual Price: USD 150

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL professionals
- Accountability Officers
- Community Engagement Officers
- Program Managers
- Protection professionals
- Humanitarian workers
- NGO and INGO staff
- Local organizations and community-based organizations

### *Course Purpose:*

This course develops the ability to design and manage effective accountability and community engagement systems that enable affected people to participate, provide feedback and influence program decisions.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Accountability Principles
2. Accountability to Affected Populations
3. Community Participation
4. Community Engagement
5. Feedback and Complaints Mechanisms
6. Designing Feedback Systems
7. Feedback Data Analysis
8. Response Mechanisms
9. Closing the Feedback Loop
10. Accountability, Safeguarding and Localization
11. Community Ownership

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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- Explain the principles of accountability to affected populations.
- Design appropriate community engagement approaches.
- Select suitable feedback and complaints mechanisms.
- Develop a functional feedback system.
- Analyze feedback data for program improvement.
- Develop response mechanisms.
- Close the feedback loop with communities.
- Integrate accountability into program management.
- Connect accountability with safeguarding and localization.
- Strengthen community participation and ownership.

### *Final Learning Output:*

A community accountability and feedback mechanism design.

## COURSE 6: ORGANIZATIONAL LEARNING AND ADAPTIVE MANAGEMENT

Level: Practitioner

Recommended Duration: 2–3 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 10–15 hours

Individual Price: USD 125

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL professionals
- Program Managers
- MEAL Managers
- Organizational learning professionals
- Senior project staff
- NGO leaders and decision-makers

### *Course Purpose:*

This course helps professionals transform evidence, reflection and experience into improved decisions, adaptive programming and organizational learning.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Learning in Organizations
2. Learning Systems
3. After-Action Reviews
4. Pause and Reflect
5. Lessons Learned
6. Knowledge Management
7. Communities of Practice
8. Learning from Failure



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## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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- 9. Evidence to Action
- 10. Adaptive Management

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Explain the role of learning in organizational performance.
- Design practical learning processes.
- Facilitate After-Action Reviews and reflection sessions.
- Capture and organize lessons learned.
- Develop mechanisms for knowledge sharing.
- Establish or contribute to Communities of Practice.
- Use evidence to support adaptive decisions.
- Create feedback loops between implementation and learning.
- Identify barriers to organizational learning.
- Support a culture of reflection and adaptation.

### *Final Learning Output:*

An organizational learning and adaptation plan.

## COURSE 7: MEAL DATA MANAGEMENT

Level: Practitioner

Recommended Duration: 3–4 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 15–20 hours

Individual Price: USD 150

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL Officers
- Data Officers
- Information Management Officers
- Monitoring Officers
- Program staff responsible for data
- MEAL Managers

### *Course Purpose:*

This course develops the ability to establish reliable systems for collecting, organizing, managing, protecting and assuring the quality of MEAL data.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. MEAL Data Management
2. Data Flow Mapping
3. Data Collection Systems

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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4. Data Storage and Organization
5. Data Cleaning
6. Data Validation
7. Data Quality Assurance
8. Data Quality Assessments
9. Data Protection and Privacy
10. Data Governance
11. Data Management SOPs

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Map the flow of data through a project or organization.
- Design basic data management processes.
- Establish data organization and storage systems.
- Apply data cleaning and validation techniques.
- Identify and address data quality problems.
- Conduct data quality assessments.
- Develop data management procedures.
- Understand data protection and privacy principles.
- Establish basic data governance arrangements.
- Develop data management SOPs.

### *Final Learning Output:*

A MEAL data management and data flow system.

## COURSE 8: MEAL DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

Level: Practitioner

Recommended Duration: 4–5 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 20–30 hours

Individual Price: USD 200

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL Officers
- Monitoring Officers
- Evaluation Officers
- Data Analysts
- Researchers
- Program Managers
- MEAL Managers

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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### *Course Purpose:*

This course develops practical skills for analyzing quantitative and qualitative data and transforming findings into meaningful conclusions and recommendations.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Data Analysis Fundamentals
2. Sampling
3. Descriptive Statistics
4. Quantitative Analysis
5. Qualitative Analysis
6. Mixed-Methods Analysis
7. Data Interpretation
8. Identifying Trends
9. Drawing Conclusions
10. Evidence-Based Recommendations

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Select appropriate data analysis approaches.
- Understand basic sampling concepts.
- Apply descriptive statistical techniques.
- Conduct basic quantitative analysis.
- Analyze qualitative information.
- Combine quantitative and qualitative findings.
- Identify patterns and trends.
- Interpret findings in context.
- Develop evidence-based conclusions.
- Formulate practical recommendations.

### *Final Learning Output:*

An analytical report based on a real or simulated MEAL dataset.

## COURSE 9: MEAL SYSTEM DESIGN

Level: Designer

Recommended Duration: 4–5 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 25–35 hours

Individual Price: USD 300

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL Managers
- Senior MEAL Officers
- MEAL Coordinators

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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- MEAL Consultants
- Program Managers
- Organizational leaders
- Professionals responsible for establishing or strengthening MEAL systems

### *Course Purpose:*

This course develops the ability to analyze, design and improve integrated MEAL systems.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Understanding MEAL Systems
2. MEAL System Diagnosis
3. MEAL Architecture
4. The 5R Framework
5. MEAL Roles and Responsibilities
6. MEAL Governance
7. MEAL Processes and Workflows
8. Data Flows
9. Tools and Resources
10. Quality Assurance
11. Policies and SOPs
12. System Integration
13. System Sustainability
14. Designing a Complete MEAL System

### *The MEAL Bridge 5R Framework:*

- Rules
- Roles
- Relationships
- Resources
- Results

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Analyze an existing MEAL system.
- Identify gaps and weaknesses in MEAL architecture.
- Design an integrated MEAL system.
- Define MEAL roles and responsibilities.
- Establish appropriate governance arrangements.
- Map MEAL processes and data flows.
- Design MEAL policies and SOPs.
- Integrate monitoring, evaluation, accountability and learning.
- Develop quality assurance mechanisms.
- Apply the 5R Framework to MEAL system design.
- Develop a practical MEAL system improvement plan.

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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### *Final Learning Output:*

A complete MEAL system design or MEAL system improvement plan.

## COURSE 10: BUILDING AND STRENGTHENING ORGANIZATIONAL MEAL FUNCTIONS

Level: Designer

Recommended Duration: 3–4 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 15–25 hours

Individual Price: USD 250

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL Managers
- Senior MEAL professionals
- NGO leaders
- Country Directors
- Program Directors
- Human Resources and organizational development professionals
- Consultants supporting organizational capacity strengthening

### *Course Purpose:*

This course focuses on the organizational capacity, structures and resources required to establish and sustain an effective MEAL function.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Understanding Organizational MEAL Functions
2. MEAL Capacity Assessment
3. MEAL Maturity Models
4. Organizational Readiness
5. Designing MEAL Functions
6. MEAL Staffing and Team Structures
7. Capacity Strengthening Plans
8. Institutionalizing MEAL
9. Organizational Performance
10. Sustainability and Handover

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Assess organizational MEAL capacity.
- Identify organizational MEAL strengths and gaps.
- Apply MEAL maturity concepts.
- Design appropriate MEAL structures.
- Define staffing and competency requirements.

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## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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- Develop MEAL capacity strengthening plans.
- Identify barriers to institutionalizing MEAL.
- Strengthen organizational ownership of MEAL.
- Develop sustainability and handover strategies.

### *Final Learning Output:*

An organizational MEAL capacity strengthening plan.

## COURSE 11: DATA VISUALIZATION, DASHBOARDS AND REPORTING

Level: Designer

Recommended Duration: 3–4 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 15–20 hours

Individual Price: USD 175

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL professionals
- Data professionals
- Information Management Officers
- Program Managers
- MEAL Managers
- Communication and reporting professionals

### *Course Purpose:*

This course develops the ability to transform MEAL data into clear visualizations, dashboards and reports that support decision-making.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Visualization Principles
2. Choosing the Right Visualization
3. Data Storytelling
4. Dashboard Design
5. KPI Dashboards
6. Reporting for Different Audiences
7. Executive Reporting
8. Donor Reporting
9. Communicating Evidence
10. Building a Complete MEAL Dashboard

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Select appropriate visualizations for different data types.

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

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- Design clear and effective charts.
- Develop meaningful dashboards.
- Select appropriate KPIs.
- Adapt reporting for different audiences.
- Communicate evidence clearly.
- Improve executive and donor reporting.
- Develop data stories.
- Build a practical MEAL dashboard.

### *Final Learning Output:*

A functional MEAL dashboard and evidence-based report.

## COURSE 12: DIGITAL MEAL AND AI

Level: Designer

Recommended Duration: 3–4 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 15–25 hours

Individual Price: USD 200

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL professionals
- Data professionals
- Program Managers
- MEAL Managers
- Digital transformation professionals
- NGO and humanitarian professionals interested in technology and AI

### *Course Purpose:*

This course explores how digital tools, automation and artificial intelligence can improve MEAL systems while maintaining ethical and responsible practices.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Digital Transformation of MEAL
2. Digital Data Collection
3. Digital MEAL Tools
4. No-Code Tools
5. Automation
6. AI for MEAL
7. Generative AI
8. AI-Assisted Analysis
9. AI-Assisted Reporting
10. Data Ethics and Privacy
11. Responsible AI

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

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### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Identify opportunities for digital transformation in MEAL.
- Select appropriate digital tools.
- Understand the role of automation.
- Apply AI tools to selected MEAL tasks.
- Use AI to support analysis and reporting.
- Identify risks related to AI and data.
- Apply responsible AI principles.
- Protect sensitive data and privacy.
- Develop a practical digital improvement plan for MEAL.

### *Final Learning Output:*

A digital MEAL transformation or AI application plan.

## COURSE 13: MEAL IN HUMANITARIAN AND CONFLICT-AFFECTED CONTEXTS

Level: Specialist

Recommended Duration: 3–4 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 15–25 hours

Individual Price: USD 200

### *Target Audience:*

- Humanitarian MEAL professionals
- NGO and INGO staff
- Emergency response professionals
- Program Managers
- MEAL Coordinators
- Professionals working in conflict-affected and fragile contexts

### *Course Purpose:*

This course focuses on adapting MEAL approaches to humanitarian emergencies, conflict-affected environments, fragile contexts and situations where access and security are constrained.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Humanitarian MEAL Principles
2. MEAL in Emergencies
3. Conflict-Sensitive MEAL
4. Do No Harm
5. Access Constraints



# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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6. Remote MEAL
7. Rapid Assessments
8. Real-Time Monitoring
9. Adaptive Programming
10. MEAL in Fragile Contexts

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Adapt MEAL systems to humanitarian contexts.
- Design approaches for constrained-access environments.
- Apply conflict-sensitive MEAL principles.
- Understand remote monitoring approaches.
- Support rapid assessment processes.
- Apply real-time monitoring principles.
- Identify risks associated with data collection in fragile contexts.
- Adapt MEAL systems to changing conditions.
- Support evidence-based adaptive programming.

### *Final Learning Output:*

A context-adapted MEAL approach for a humanitarian or conflict-affected program.

## COURSE 14: ADVANCED EVALUATION METHODS

Level: Specialist

Recommended Duration: 4–5 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 20–30 hours

Individual Price: USD 300

### *Target Audience:*

- Experienced MEAL professionals
- Evaluation specialists
- Researchers
- Senior MEAL Managers
- Evaluation consultants
- Professionals with foundational evaluation knowledge

### *Course Purpose:*

This advanced course introduces complex evaluation approaches and advanced methods for assessing contribution, causality and change.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. Causal Thinking

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2. Counterfactuals
3. Experimental Designs
4. Quasi-Experimental Designs
5. Causal Inference
6. Contribution Analysis
7. Outcome Harvesting
8. Most Significant Change
9. Developmental Evaluation
10. Complexity-Aware Evaluation

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Apply causal thinking to evaluation.
- Understand counterfactual reasoning.
- Distinguish experimental and quasi-experimental designs.
- Understand causal inference concepts.
- Apply contribution analysis.
- Understand outcome harvesting.
- Apply Most Significant Change approaches.
- Understand developmental evaluation.
- Apply complexity-aware evaluation principles.
- Select appropriate advanced evaluation approaches.

### *Final Learning Output:*

An advanced evaluation design or methodology plan.

## COURSE 15: THIRD-PARTY MONITORING AND INDEPENDENT VERIFICATION

Level: Specialist

Recommended Duration: 3–4 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 15–25 hours

Individual Price: USD 250

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL professionals
- TPM Officers
- MEAL Managers
- Monitoring consultants
- Independent verification professionals
- NGO and INGO staff
- Donor representatives and program managers

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### *Course Purpose:*

This course develops practical knowledge and skills for designing, managing and quality-assuring third-party monitoring and independent verification systems.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. TPM Fundamentals
2. TPM Models
3. TPM Methodologies
4. Designing TPM Systems
5. Remote TPM
6. Data Collection for TPM
7. Data Quality in TPM
8. Independent Verification
9. TPM Reporting
10. Quality Assurance
11. Managing TPM Projects

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Explain the purpose and role of TPM.
- Distinguish between different TPM models.
- Select appropriate TPM methodologies.
- Design a TPM approach.
- Apply remote monitoring methods.
- Establish TPM data quality mechanisms.
- Understand independent verification.
- Develop TPM reporting systems.
- Establish quality assurance procedures.
- Manage TPM assignments and projects.

### *Final Learning Output:*

A complete TPM design or independent verification plan.

## COURSE 16: MEAL LEADERSHIP AND MANAGEMENT

Level: Lead

Recommended Duration: 3–4 days

Recommended Learning Hours: 15–25 hours

Individual Price: USD 250

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL Managers
- MEAL Coordinators

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## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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- Senior MEAL Officers
- Program Managers
- Country and Program Directors
- Experienced MEAL professionals

### *Course Purpose:*

This course develops the leadership, management and strategic capabilities required to lead MEAL teams and influence organizational decision-making.

### *Core Sessions:*

1. The Role of the MEAL Manager
2. MEAL Team Structures
3. Strategic MEAL Management
4. MEAL Work Planning
5. MEAL Budgeting
6. Resource Planning
7. Managing MEAL Teams
8. Managing Consultants
9. Influencing Without Authority
10. Leading Organizational Learning
11. Evidence-Based Leadership

### *Learning Outcomes:*

Participants will be able to:

- Understand the strategic role of MEAL leadership.
- Design appropriate MEAL team structures.
- Develop MEAL workplans.
- Plan MEAL resources and budgets.
- Manage MEAL teams effectively.
- Manage consultants and external technical support.
- Influence organizational decisions using evidence.
- Lead organizational learning.
- Strengthen the strategic positioning of MEAL.

### *Final Learning Output:*

A strategic MEAL leadership and management plan.

## 3. PROFESSIONAL LEARNING PATHWAYS

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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## PATHWAY 1: MEAL EXPLORER

### *Purpose:*

An entry pathway for individuals who are new to MEAL or exploring whether to pursue a career in the field.

Individual Course Value: USD 135

Recommended Pathway Price: USD 110

### *Target Audience:*

- Students
- Graduates
- Career changers
- Volunteers
- Junior NGO staff
- Individuals with no formal MEAL experience

### *Included Courses:*

1. MEAL Fundamentals
2. Building a MEAL Career

### *Expected Outcome:*

Participants understand the MEAL profession, the basic MEAL framework and their own potential career development pathway.

### *Final Pathway Output:*

Personal MEAL Career Development Plan and Basic MEAL Framework.

## PATHWAY 2: MEAL PRACTITIONER

### *Purpose:*

The core professional pathway for individuals who want broad practical competence across the major MEAL functions.

Individual Course Value: USD 1,050

Recommended Pathway Price: USD 795

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL Assistants
- Junior and mid-level MEAL Officers
- Project Officers
- Program Officers
- NGO professionals moving into MEAL
- Professionals seeking comprehensive MEAL development

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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### *Included Courses:*

1. MEAL Fundamentals
2. Monitoring and Indicator Systems
3. Evaluation Design and Practice
4. Accountability and Community Engagement
5. Organizational Learning and Adaptive Management
6. MEAL Data Management
7. MEAL Data Analysis and Interpretation

### *Expected Outcome:*

Participants develop broad practical competence across monitoring, evaluation, accountability, learning, data management and data analysis.

### *Final Pathway Output:*

A complete MEAL portfolio including:

- Monitoring and indicator framework
- Evaluation design
- Accountability mechanism
- Data management system
- Analytical report
- Organizational learning plan

## PATHWAY 3: MEAL SYSTEMS DESIGNER

### *Purpose:*

A professional pathway for individuals who want to design, review and strengthen integrated MEAL systems.

Individual Course Value: USD 675

Recommended Pathway Price: USD 525

### *Target Audience:*

- MEAL Coordinators
- MEAL Managers
- Senior MEAL Officers
- MEAL Consultants
- Program Managers
- Organizational development professionals

### *Included Courses:*

1. MEAL Fundamentals
2. Monitoring and Indicator Systems
3. MEAL Data Management
4. MEAL System Design

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### *Expected Outcome:*

Participants can analyze an organization's MEAL needs and design integrated systems, processes and structures.

### *Final Pathway Output:*

A complete MEAL system design package.

## PATHWAY 4: MEAL DATA AND DIGITAL SPECIALIST

### *Purpose:*

A future-focused pathway for professionals specializing in data, digital tools, dashboards, automation and AI-supported MEAL.

Individual Course Value: USD 725

Recommended Pathway Price: USD 575

### *Target Audience:*

- Data Officers
- MEAL Officers
- Information Management Officers
- Data Analysts
- MEAL Managers
- Digital transformation professionals

### *Included Courses:*

1. MEAL Data Management
2. MEAL Data Analysis and Interpretation
3. Data Visualization, Dashboards and Reporting
4. Digital MEAL and AI

### *Expected Outcome:*

Participants can manage MEAL data, analyze information, develop dashboards and identify responsible applications of digital tools and AI.

### *Final Pathway Output:*

A complete digital MEAL improvement package including:

- Data flow system
- Analytical product
- MEAL dashboard
- Digital transformation or AI application plan

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### PATHWAY 5: HUMANITARIAN MEAL SPECIALIST

#### *Purpose:*

A specialized pathway for professionals working in humanitarian, conflict-affected and fragile environments.

Individual Course Value: USD 775

Recommended Pathway Price: USD 625

#### *Target Audience:*

- Humanitarian MEAL professionals
- NGO and INGO staff
- Emergency response professionals
- MEAL Coordinators
- Program Managers
- Professionals working in fragile contexts

#### *Included Courses:*

1. MEAL Fundamentals
2. MEAL in Humanitarian and Conflict-Affected Contexts
3. Monitoring and Indicator Systems
4. Accountability and Community Engagement
5. Evaluation Design and Practice

#### *Expected Outcome:*

Participants can adapt MEAL approaches to humanitarian and conflict-affected environments.

#### *Final Pathway Output:*

A context-adapted humanitarian MEAL framework.

### PATHWAY 6: MEAL EVALUATION SPECIALIST

#### *Purpose:*

A technical pathway for professionals seeking advanced evaluation expertise.

Individual Course Value: USD 775

Recommended Pathway Price: USD 625

#### *Target Audience:*

- Evaluation Officers
- Senior MEAL Officers
- MEAL Managers
- Researchers
- Evaluation consultants
- Professionals with foundational MEAL knowledge



# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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### *Included Courses:*

1. MEAL Fundamentals
2. Evaluation Design and Practice
3. MEAL Data Analysis and Interpretation
4. Advanced Evaluation Methods

### *Expected Outcome:*

Participants develop the ability to design, analyze and manage increasingly complex evaluations.

### *Final Pathway Output:*

An advanced evaluation portfolio.

## PATHWAY 7: MEAL MANAGER

### *Purpose:*

A leadership pathway for experienced professionals moving toward MEAL management and organizational leadership.

Individual Course Value: USD 1,000

Recommended Pathway Price: USD 795

### *Target Audience:*

- Senior MEAL Officers
- MEAL Coordinators
- MEAL Managers
- Program Managers
- Country and Program Directors
- Experienced NGO professionals

### *Included Courses:*

1. MEAL Fundamentals
2. MEAL System Design
3. Building and Strengthening Organizational MEAL Functions
4. Organizational Learning and Adaptive Management
5. MEAL Leadership and Management

### *Expected Outcome:*

Participants develop the strategic, organizational and leadership capabilities required to lead MEAL functions.

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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### *Final Pathway Output:*

A strategic MEAL leadership and organizational improvement portfolio.

## 4. COMPLETE ACADEMY PASS

### *Product Name:*

MEAL Bridge Professional Academy Pass

### *Purpose:*

A comprehensive professional development product providing access to the full MEAL Bridge Academy catalogue.

Total Individual Course Catalogue Value: USD 2,785

Recommended Initial Academy Pass Price: USD 1,500–1,800 annually

Working Reference Price: USD 1,650 annually

### *Potential Inclusions:*

- Access to all eligible flagship courses
- Access to professional learning pathways
- Course completion certificates
- Professional development resources
- Selected Academy events
- Community of Practice access
- Career development resources
- Alumni benefits
- Discounts on selected advanced programs and workshops

### *Important:*

The Academy Pass should only be launched when sufficient course content, learning support and Academy infrastructure exist to justify the value of the product.

## 5. INSTITUTIONAL TRAINING STRUCTURE

Institutional training should not use the same pricing model as individual enrollment.

### *Institutional pricing should be based on:*

- Course complexity
- Number of participants
- Delivery duration
- Customization required
- Preparation time
- Assessment requirements

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## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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- Certification
- Facilitator requirements
- Organizational needs
- Required practical outputs

Institutional delivery should be divided into three formats.

### *FORMAT A: STANDARD INSTITUTIONAL TRAINING*

The existing MEAL Bridge course is delivered to an organization's staff with limited customization.

### *FORMAT B: CUSTOMIZED INSTITUTIONAL TRAINING*

The course is adapted to the organization's:

- Sector
- Country context
- Program portfolio
- Donor requirements
- Existing MEAL systems
- Organizational needs

### *FORMAT C: APPLIED ORGANIZATIONAL MEAL PROGRAM*

A broader engagement combining:

- Assessment
- Training
- Practical application
- Coaching
- System improvement
- Follow-up review

This may become a consulting engagement rather than a standard training product.

## 6. INDICATIVE INSTITUTIONAL PRICING TIERS

### TIER 1 — FOUNDATION

#### *Courses:*

- MEAL Fundamentals
- Building a MEAL Career

Indicative Standard Institutional Price: USD 800–1,500 per cohort

#### *Typical Audience:*

15–50 participants

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### TIER 2 — CORE PRACTITIONER

#### *Courses:*

- Monitoring and Indicator Systems
- Evaluation Design and Practice
- Accountability and Community Engagement
- Organizational Learning and Adaptive Management
- MEAL Data Management
- MEAL Data Analysis and Interpretation

Indicative Standard Institutional Price: USD 1,200–3,000 per cohort

Final pricing depends on course complexity and delivery requirements.

### TIER 3 — SYSTEMS AND DIGITAL

#### *Courses:*

- MEAL System Design
- Building and Strengthening Organizational MEAL Functions
- Data Visualization, Dashboards and Reporting
- Digital MEAL and AI

Indicative Standard Institutional Price: USD 2,000–5,000 per cohort

### TIER 4 — SPECIALIST AND LEADERSHIP

#### *Courses:*

- MEAL in Humanitarian and Conflict-Affected Contexts
- Advanced Evaluation Methods
- Third-Party Monitoring and Independent Verification
- MEAL Leadership and Management

Indicative Standard Institutional Price: USD 2,000–5,000+ per cohort

## 7. ORGANIZATIONAL MEAL CAPACITY PROGRAMS

For organizations requiring more than training, MEAL Bridge may offer integrated capacity-strengthening programs.

A typical program may include:

### PHASE 1 — ASSESSMENT

- Organizational MEAL capacity assessment

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## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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- Existing system review
- Stakeholder consultations
- Capacity and maturity analysis

### PHASE 2 — TRAINING

- Selected Academy courses
- Customized sessions
- Practical workshops

### PHASE 3 — APPLICATION

- Participants apply learning to their own systems
- MEAL tools and processes are developed
- Organizational systems are reviewed

### PHASE 4 — COACHING

- Technical support
- Review of outputs
- Practical guidance

### PHASE 5 — FOLLOW-UP

- Progress assessment
- System review
- Recommendations for continued improvement

### Indicative Price:

USD 5,000–15,000+

#### *Final price depends on:*

- Organization size
- Number of locations
- Program complexity
- Scope of assessment
- Number of participants
- Level of customization
- Duration of engagement
- Required consulting outputs

## 8. PRICING PRINCIPLES

MEAL Bridge should use the following pricing principles:

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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1. Standard public prices should reflect the value of the learning product.
2. Affordability should be addressed through targeted access mechanisms rather than permanently underpricing the Academy.
3. Early enrollment discounts may provide approximately 10–15% savings.
4. Student and unemployed learner discounts may provide approximately 20–40% savings where appropriate.
5. Scholarships may provide partial or full financial support for selected learners.
6. Alumni may receive discounts on future learning products.
7. Institutional pricing should be based on the value and complexity of delivery rather than simply multiplying the individual course price by the number of participants.
8. Customized training should carry an additional customization fee.
9. Applied organizational MEAL programs should be priced as capacity-strengthening or consulting engagements rather than ordinary courses.
10. Course prices should be reviewed after the curriculum, delivery hours, assessment requirements and instructor workload are finalized.

## 9. FINAL ACADEMY PRODUCT ARCHITECTURE

The MEAL Bridge Academy product structure is:

### FREE ACCESS

- Knowledge Hub
- Articles
- Resources
- Introductory webinars
- Selected community activities

### INDIVIDUAL COURSES

- MEAL Fundamentals
- Building a MEAL Career
- Monitoring and Indicator Systems
- Evaluation Design and Practice
- Accountability and Community Engagement
- Organizational Learning and Adaptive Management
- MEAL Data Management
- MEAL Data Analysis and Interpretation
- MEAL System Design
- Building and Strengthening Organizational MEAL Functions
- Data Visualization, Dashboards and Reporting
- Digital MEAL and AI
- MEAL in Humanitarian and Conflict-Affected Contexts
- Advanced Evaluation Methods
- Third-Party Monitoring and Independent Verification
- MEAL Leadership and Management

# MEAL BRIDGE ACADEMY

## COURSE CATALOGUE AND LEARNING PATHWAYS

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### PROFESSIONAL PATHWAYS

- MEAL Explorer
- MEAL Practitioner
- MEAL Systems Designer
- MEAL Data and Digital Specialist
- Humanitarian MEAL Specialist
- MEAL Evaluation Specialist
- MEAL Manager

### INSTITUTIONAL OFFERINGS

- Standard Institutional Training
- Customized Institutional Training
- Organizational MEAL Capacity Strengthening
- MEAL System Design and Consulting

The Academy therefore serves both individual professional development and organizational capacity strengthening while maintaining a clear separation between education, training and consulting.